

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

Emeryville, CA

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Regular climber, front-of-house professional, and community builder based minutes from Berkeley Ironworks. EMT-certified (2024), with two years inside IBM's Customer Support organization and three years running my own client-facing consulting practice, where I am the first and only point of contact for every customer. I grew a multilingual online community for a music startup and am launching a waterfront gathering series for the Bay Area outdoor community. My consulting schedule is deliberately flexible, so I can reliably cover evening and weekend shifts.

Core Competencies

- **Customer & member service:** greeting, listening, and resolving concerns as the sole point of contact for consulting clients; equally comfortable with executives, engineers, and non-technical customers
- **Climbing, safety & emergency response:** regular climber, comfortable with belaying, grades, and gym safety practices; EMT-certified (2024); AIARE 1 avalanche safety and rescue (2022); trained to assess a scene, enforce safety protocols, and stay calm under pressure
- **Community building:** grew a global, multilingual Discord community for a music startup; organizing "Ocean-Tech" lightning-talk gatherings that bring Bay Area engineers, founders, and sailors together on the water
- **Computers & front-of-house systems:** 7+ years of professional software work; quick to master any POS, waiver, membership, or reservation system
- **Self-directed multitasking & sales:** sell, schedule, deliver, invoice, and support solo as a founder; comfortable switching contexts in a busy environment; live aboard and maintain a 1966 sailboat, where daily upkeep is non-negotiable
- **Languages:** English (native), Spanish (conversational)

Professional Experience

- **StaffRoom AI** **Emeryville, CA**
Founder & AI Solutions Consultant *2023–Present*
 - Own every client relationship end-to-end: first conversation, scoping, delivery, and ongoing support for engagements up to \$18K, staying the single point of contact throughout
 - Lead discovery workshops that surface what customers actually need, then translate technical work into plain language for non-technical teams
 - Trained and supported an agency team through a new content production system, owning enablement and change management as production volume grew 10x
 - Handle my own scheduling, communications, and billing while juggling multiple concurrent clients, a daily exercise in composed multitasking
- **Wiz Music** **Barcelona, Spain**
Community Development Intern *2022*
 - Grew and stewarded a global, multilingual (English/Spanish/Catalan) Discord community around a music startup, welcoming newcomers and keeping day-to-day engagement healthy
 - Built Python automation to streamline investor outreach
- **Valhalla Healthcare** **Remote**
Machine Learning Engineer (Intern) *2021*
 - Shipped an ML tool that a non-technical clinical team could actually use, translating handwritten notes into structured data

- **IBM** **Austin, TX**
Data Engineer / Cognitive Software Engineer, Customer Support *2018–2020*
 - Worked inside IBM's Customer Support organization building tools for front-line support engineers, cutting time-to-resolution for the most common customer issues to a single response
 - Eliminated 1–3 hours of per-case prep work for support engineers by automating log analysis
 - Led collaborative design sessions with support teams and stakeholders, and authored plain-language release notes guiding customers through product changes
- **IBM** **Austin, TX**
Research Intern, ThinkLab *2017*
 - Built interactive VR/AR exhibits that welcomed and oriented visitors to IBM's research showcase space

Education & Certifications

- **University of Colorado Boulder** **Boulder, CO**
B.S. Information Science *2018–2023*
Major GPA 3.7 · Certificate of Cognitive Science · Dean's List (Fall 2019, Spring 2023). Senior capstone: Gamifying Outdoor Education in Software.
- **RC Health Services** *2024*
Emergency Medical Technician
- **AIARE 1 Avalanche Safety and Rescue** *2022*

Community & Leadership

- **Ocean-Tech gatherings** (early stage): organizing lightning-talk events bringing Bay Area engineers, founders, and sailors together on the water
- **Executive Council, Alpha Phi Delta**, CU Boulder (2019–2021): modernized recruitment and operations record-keeping for a student community
- **2nd Place, IBM Hackathon for Racial Justice**, Team Lead of a diverse intern team (2020)

References

- Available upon request.